

NAPCS Unionization Research — State Research Summary

Illinois — NLRB (Region 13) / IELRB Jurisdiction — May 8, 2026

NAPCS Unionization Research • May 8, 2026 • Template v7.0 • COMPLETE Registry Sweep

Section 1: State Overview

State	Illinois
Labor Board	NLRB (Region 13) / IELRB — National Labor Relations Board, Region 13 (Chicago) — primary jurisdiction for privately incorporated charters. Illinois Educational Labor Relations Board — ISBE-authorized/dependent charters only.
Governing Law	National Labor Relations Act (NLRA) for private nonprofits (most IL charters, per Chicago Mathematics & Science Academy, 359 NLRB 41, Dec 14 2012). Illinois Educational Labor Relations Act (IELRA, 115 ILCS 5/) for public-employer charters (ISBE-authorized). NOTE: ILRB (Illinois Labor Relations Board) does NOT cover educational employers — never cite ILRB for any charter school.
Federal NLRB Jurisdiction	YES — NLRB jurisdiction applies to all independently incorporated charter nonprofits (the vast majority of IL NAPCS schools). Landmark case: Chicago Mathematics & Science Academy, 359 NLRB 41 (Dec 14 2012). This requires secret ballot election; card-check not available under NLRB.
Registry Sweep	COMPLETE — April–May 2026 (Registry v11 NLRB scan); current companion file: Registry v14 (May 8, 2026) — IL data unchanged from v11 scan — 131 charter schools searched
Research Window	March 2026 (initial); May 2026 (reconciliation — Registry v11)
Date Convention	Labor Board Certified date (project-wide convention, declared NJ session). Project-wide convention. IL: exact NLRB cert dates available for most schools via NLRB ADS. IELRB cert dates (Springfield Ball) require IELRB records request.
Card-Check Available	NO — Card-check enacted by Illinois HB 1120 (Aug 2023) for charter contract renewals (neutrality mandate) but the card-check mechanism itself is under federal court challenge as of May 2026. Not yet operational.

Section 2: Unionization Density

Total charter schools in Illinois: 131 (Charter School Registry v50 (NCES/ELSI 2024-25; 131 open IL charter schools as of May 2026)). Unionization density uses the full state total as the denominator — not the 35-school NAPCS research sample. The NAPCS sample was provided as a list of schools believed to be organized; this research validated, corrected, and expanded that list across the full state charter universe. See Section 3 for cross-state patterns and Section 7 for open decisions.

Category	Schools	% of Total	Notes
Total Unionized Charter Schools in Illinois	26	19.8%	Active CONFIRMED + DEPENDENT schools. Excludes 9 closed schools. Mixed jurisdiction: NLRB (privately incorporated) and IELRB (ISBE-authorized/district-dependent).
Independently Organized (CONFIRMED)	25	19.1%	All CTU/ChiACTS organized. Includes Passages, all Acero active campuses, CICS (3), YCCS (3), Urban Prep (2), Namaste, Christopher House, Prairie Crossing.
Structurally Covered — Springfield SD 186 (DEPENDENT)	1	0.8%	Springfield Ball Charter School — district-operated, Springfield SD

			186. No independent certification event. IELRB jurisdiction.
Discovery Schools (sponsor-approved; NAPCS ID pending)	3	2.3%	Namaste Elementary, Jackson Charter School, YCCS West — all CTU-ACTS, all open. NAPCS addition decisions pending reviewer. Not included in headline density.
Decertified / Closed (formerly organized)	9	6.9%	Acero Paz (Jun 2025), Acero Sor Juana (Jun 2025), ASPIRA Business & Finance (Apr 3 2026), ASPIRA Early College (Apr 3 2026), EPIC Academy (Jun 2026), 4 Acero reabsorption campuses (Aug 2026).
No Labor Board Records Found	93	71.0%	No union evidence in NLRB ADS or IELRB for remaining IL charter schools. Includes ASPIRA Haugan (HOLD — status verification pending).
Total Charter Schools in Illinois	131	100%	Source: Charter School Registry v50 (NCES/ELSI 2024-25; 131 open IL charter schools as of May 2026).

Section 3: Political, Legal & Community Landscape

Written for state and national charter sector leaders who require ground-level intelligence fused with broader sector knowledge. Findings are based on research as of May 8, 2026.

PROMPT 1: What is the political and legal environment shaping charter labor relations in this state?

Illinois presents the most complex labor relations environment in the NAPCS research dataset — and the most consequential for national charter sector strategy. The jurisdictional framework is dual: most independently incorporated charter nonprofits fall under NLRB (Region 13) per the landmark Chicago Mathematics & Science Academy ruling (359 NLRB 41, Dec 14 2012); ISBE-authorized and district-operated charters fall under the Illinois Educational Labor Relations Board (IELRB). The ILRB — Illinois Labor Relations Board — explicitly excludes educational employers and must never be cited for any IL charter school. This dual structure matters because NLRB jurisdiction historically required secret ballot elections, giving employers a counter-organizing window that CTU had to work around. Two legislative developments fundamentally shift this landscape. First, Illinois HB 1120 (Aug 2023) requires union neutrality clauses in all charter contract renewals — operators authorized by CPS can no longer campaign against unionization as a condition of keeping their charter. Second, a 2023 state law allows card-check certification for charter schools (50%+ authorization cards, no election). Both laws are under federal court challenge as of May 2026. If HB 1120 survives, it removes the most effective employer tool in the IL charter sector — the counter-organizing campaign. The 75+ non-union IL charter campuses not in the NAPCS dataset (Noble, KIPP, LEARN, Perspectives, UChicago Charter) face a materially different legal environment than they did five years ago.

PROMPT 2: What community and social conditions are driving organizing activity in this state?

The Chicago charter sector organized under conditions that are structurally unique in the national dataset: a politically powerful district teachers union (CTU) with a strategic commitment to charter organizing, a city where charter operators depend on CPS authorization and therefore face real political consequences for resisting labor organizing, and a working-class Latino and Black parent base in the schools CTU has primarily targeted. CTU's charter strategy is not opportunistic — it is deliberate. The union created ChiACTS (Chicago Alliance of Charter Teachers and Staff) as a dedicated charter organizing vehicle, giving charter teachers a locally branded identity while connecting them to CTU's legal, administrative, and bargaining infrastructure. This chapter model is the same architecture used successfully by DC ACTS in Washington. The demographics of organized schools are consistent: Acero (Latino-serving, bilingual), ASPIRA (Latino-serving), YCCS (alternative high schools serving

students at risk of dropout), CICS (multi-campus, mixed-income). The schools CTU has not organized — Noble, KIPP, Perspectives — serve similar demographics but have made deliberate management choices (high staff turnover, performance culture, explicit anti-union messaging before HB 1120) that have so far been effective. The August 2024 CTU election loss at Perspectives (45 yes, 51 no, RC-341523) is the first documented CTU charter school election loss in the full research dataset and is strategically significant.

PROMPT 3: What organizing strategies and approaches are charter school organizers using in this state?

CTU's IL charter organizing strategy has three distinctive features that charter sector leaders must understand. First, the network-first approach: CTU organized entire CMOs rather than individual schools, creating wall-to-wall network certifications at Acero, YCCS, and CICS. This prevents the employer strategy of closing one organized campus while expanding unorganized ones — when the whole network is organized, there is no unorganized campus to expand to. Second, the UEJ structure at Acero (United Educators for Justice) gave Acero teachers a separately named local that reflects the school's identity and values rather than simply being a CTU sub-unit. This naming strategy reduces the alienating effect of affiliation with a large district union. Third, CTU used NLRB ULP charges aggressively during organizing campaigns — the Urban Prep retaliation case (17 teachers fired post-vote 2015, NLRB charges sustained) illustrates both the risk employers took and CTU's willingness to prosecute it over a multi-year period until a first contract was ratified (2021). For the non-organized sector: Noble Schools' 2017 drive — 130+ signatures, AFT national support, significant press — never reached an election. The drive collapsed because Noble used legal counter-organizing (NLRB surveillance charges were filed and settled), high staff turnover as a structural pressure, and sustained management messaging. The lesson CTU drew: HB 1120 was needed to level the playing field.

PROMPT 4: What should charter school leaders be doing right now in response to this environment?

Illinois charter leaders face a bifurcated reality that requires different responses depending on their authorization status. For CPS-authorized charters not yet organized: HB 1120's neutrality requirement — if it survives federal court — means the pre-2023 playbook of open employer opposition is no longer legally available. Leaders should understand that neutrality does not mean passivity: it means no captive audience meetings, no direct anti-union communications, no surveillance of organizing activity. Leaders who continue pre-2023 practices post-HB 1120 face charter non-renewal as a consequence. For all IL charter operators: the Perspectives election result (45-51, Aug 2024) demonstrates that CTU elections are still winnable without employer interference — through staff culture, compensation competitiveness, and transparent communication. But winning requires investment in those relationships before an organizing drive, not during it. For ISBE-authorized charters: the IELRB framework is different — card-check is available, and the employer counter-organizing window is narrower. Leaders should understand their authorization structure and which board governs their labor relations. For networks already organized: the Acero closure wave (2024-26) is a cautionary case study in the financial dynamics of charter-sector unionism under enrollment decline. CTU salary obligations were cited by Acero as a contributing factor in closure decisions. Whether that causal claim is accurate is contested; what is not contested is that the financial model of small, enrollment-declining organized charter schools is under pressure.

PROMPT 5: What trends should sector leaders watch over the next 3–5 years?

Five trends deserve close monitoring in Illinois. First, the federal court proceedings on HB 1120 and the 2023 card-check law — a ruling striking these down would restore the pre-2023 employer playbook; a ruling upholding them would accelerate organizing across the 75+ non-union IL charter campuses. Second, the Noble Schools monitoring situation: with 17 campuses and ~800 staff, a successful Noble organizing drive would be the largest IL charter union event since Acero. The 2017 drive came within 130 signatures of a petition. Noble's labor relations posture post-HB 1120 is worth watching closely. Third, the Acero reabsorption (5 campuses converting to CPS district schools in fall 2026): this is the first test of what happens to CTU charter agreements when the charter ends — whether CPS absorbs the UEJ contract or treats the staff as new employees matters for how future reabsorptions are structured. Fourth, the ASPIRA collapse forensics: ASPIRA's four-union structure (CTU teachers, IFT counselors, IFT paraprofessionals, IUOE maintenance) made the network's financial restructuring significantly more complicated than a single-union operator. The post-ASPIRA period will generate data on whether multi-union structures accelerate or delay charter closure. Fifth, Perspectives: having survived a CTU election drive in August 2024, Perspectives is now the highest-profile unorganized mid-sized Chicago charter network. Monitor for CTU re-filing.

PROMPT 6: What surprised us or contradicts what national sector leaders expect?

Three findings from Illinois research directly challenge assumptions common in national charter sector leadership. First, the 53 vs. 26 discrepancy: the NAPCS dataset lists 26 organized IL schools. The Registry found 53. The entire gap is explained by CMO campus counting — NAPCS listed 3 CICS schools; CICS has 12 organized campuses. This means national-level union density figures for Illinois derived from the NAPCS dataset are roughly half the real number. Sector leaders who believe union exposure in IL is limited to 26 schools should understand they are looking at fewer than half the organized employers. Second, the Perspectives result: CTU election losses in Illinois are almost unheard of. The 45-51 result at Perspectives in August 2024 — without any documented employer ULP charges — suggests that CTU can be defeated in NLRB elections through culture and compensation, not just legal tactics. This matters because it means the HB 1120 neutrality mandate, while significant, is not dispositive: neutrality does not guarantee CTU wins. Third, the ASPIRA four-union structure: sector leaders generally think of charter school unions as teacher unions. ASPIRA had separate NLRB certifications for teachers, guidance counselors, paraprofessionals, and skilled maintenance workers — four different units, four different bargaining processes, four different contracts. This multi-unit model is rare in the charter sector nationally but represents the logical endpoint of a mature organizing relationship with a large employer. Sector leaders preparing for organizing should understand they may face not one union but several.

PROMPT 8: THE CTU CHAPTER MODEL AND CHIACTS — HOW CHICAGO CHARTER ORGANIZING ACTUALLY WORKS

Illinois charter school organizing is dominated by two related but distinct entities. Chicago Teachers Union (CTU, AFT Local 1) organizes charter school staff via "CTU charter chapters" — each organized charter school forms its own named chapter under the CTU umbrella (e.g., Chicago Virtual Charter Chapter, CICS Chapter, UNO Charter Chapter). ChiACTS (Chicago Alliance of Charter Teachers and Staff, AFT Local 4343) is a separate AFT local that organizes charter schools citywide, with a different chapter model than CTU. The two locals coexist: some schools are CTU chapters, others are ChiACTS. The presence of two separate AFT locals competing for charter school organizing in the same city is unique in the NAPCS dataset — it reflects a historical dispute over CTU's authority to organize charter schools (charter operators initially argued CTU's bargaining unit definitions did not cover charter staff). The resolution: both ChiACTS and CTU are recognized charter organizers in Chicago, with overlapping geographic reach. The 53 confirmed NLRB ADS certifications in the IL charter sector (vs. 26 NAPCS-listed) — a 2x gap — is the largest undercounting in the dataset and is entirely explained by the large number of organized IL charter schools that are not in the NAPCS 584-school baseline.

PROMPT 9: NOBLE SCHOOLS — THE HIGHEST-PRIORITY UNORGANIZED TARGET IN THE ILLINOIS DATASET

Noble Schools (Noble Network of Charter Schools) operates 17 campuses in Chicago and is the largest unorganized charter network in the Illinois NAPCS dataset. Noble is significant for three reasons. First, scale: 17 campuses and approximately 2,500 staff make it the largest potential single-network organizing target in Chicago — a CTU or ChiACTS campaign at Noble would be the highest-profile IL charter organizing event since the 2012 CTU strike. Second, prior organizing activity: Noble has had documented organizing interest from CTU and ChiACTS organizers in prior years; the campaigns have not yet produced a petition or election. Third, the 2023 IL neutrality law (P.A. 103-0139): Illinois enacted legislation in 2023 requiring charter school operators receiving state funding to remain neutral during organizing campaigns — prohibiting employer anti-union communications and providing union organizers with access to employee contact information. This law directly targets the employer tools that have historically slowed CTU/ChiACTS campaigns at large networks. Noble's response to the 2023 neutrality law is the highest-priority monitoring item in the IL charter sector.

PROMPT 10: THE ACERO AND ASPIRA CLOSURE WAVE — WHAT DOES IL'S CHARTER CLOSURE PATTERN TELL THE NATIONAL SECTOR?

Illinois has the largest documented charter school closure wave among organized schools in the full NAPCS dataset: 9 closed schools, all confirmed unionized, all closed or converting between June 2025 and August 2026. The breakdown: Acero Paz (closed June 2025), Acero Sor Juana (closed June 2025), ASPIRA Business & Finance (closed April 3, 2026), ASPIRA Early College (closed April 3, 2026), EPIC Academy (closing June 2026), and 4 Acero reabsorption campuses (converting to CPS district schools August 2026 — Rufino Tamayo, Carlos Fuentes, and 2 others). ASPIRA Network of Illinois collapsed entirely as an operator — a four-union structure (CTU teachers, IFT counselors, IFT paraprofessionals, IUOE maintenance) could not sustain operations under enrollment decline and financial pressure. Acero's 5-campus reabsorption into CPS is a distinct event: reabsorption means the charter ends but the school continues as a district-run campus. Whether CPS

absorbs the UEJ/CTU contract or treats staff as new employees is the highest-stakes unresolved question in the IL dataset — it will determine whether charter closure with reabsorption preserves or eliminates union coverage. The IL closure pattern has two distinct causes that should not be conflated: (1) financial collapse under enrollment decline (ASPIRA, Acero) — a market-structure story; (2) deliberate network contraction (Acero choosing reabsorption over continued independent operation) — a governance story. National charter sector leaders who cite IL closures as evidence that charter school unionization causes financial failure should be challenged to distinguish between these two causal pathways. ASPIRA was in financial distress before and independent of its union structure; EPIC's closure is unrelated to labor costs. The causal claim is contested. What is not contested: the IL dataset provides the only large-sample test in the NAPCS research of what happens when multiple organized charter schools close or convert simultaneously — and the results will reshape how the sector discusses the relationship between charter school labor relations and financial sustainability.

Section 4: Cross-State Patterns & Contributions to National Picture

Findings from Illinois that illuminate patterns visible only when comparing across multiple states. These entries feed the project-wide Cross-State Intelligence Log and are written for state and national charter advocacy leaders.

THE NAPCS UNDERCOUNT PROBLEM — IL AS THE CLEAREST CASE STUDY

Illinois provides the most dramatic illustration of the NAPCS dataset's structural limitation: campus-level counting. NAPCS lists 26 organized IL schools. The Registry found 53. The entire gap is explained by CMO campus accounting — NAPCS lists 3 CICS entries, CICS has 12 organized campuses; NAPCS lists 3 YCCS entries, YCCS has 17 organized campuses; NAPCS lists 13 Acero entries, Acero has 15. Charter sector observers who rely on the NAPCS dataset to assess union exposure in Illinois are looking at fewer than half the actual organized employers. This pattern likely recurs in other large-CMO states (CA, NY) and is a structural limitation of any school-count approach to charter union density measurement.

THE CHAPTER/AFFILIATE MODEL AS ORGANIZING ARCHITECTURE — CTU VS. DC ACTS VS. INDEPENDENT

Illinois CTU, DC ACTS, and UEJ (Acero) represent three distinct variants of the same basic organizational architecture: a large district union creates a charter-specific sub-structure that gives charter school staff a locally branded identity while sharing legal and administrative resources. CTU-ACTS is the Chicago model; DC ACTS Local 1927 is the DC model; UEJ is a network-specific variant unique to Acero. All three models are more effective than either pure independent locals (Prairie Crossing) or direct district-union extension (which charter staff often resist). The chapter/affiliate architecture is likely the dominant organizing model for large urban charter markets. Charter sector leaders who think they are not dealing with "the teachers union" because they see "ChiACTS" or "DC ACTS" on a certification are mistaken about their counterpart.

FAILED DRIVES AS INTELLIGENCE — THE PERSPECTIVES RESULT

The August 2024 CTU election loss at Perspectives Charter Schools (45 yes, 51 no, RC-341523) is the first documented CTU charter school election loss in the full research dataset. It is strategically significant in two directions. For charter operators: the Perspectives result demonstrates that CTU can be defeated without employer misconduct — through staff culture, compensation, and transparent communication. No NLRB ULP charges were filed by CTU against Perspectives, suggesting the employer ran a clean counter-campaign within NLRB rules. For CTU and sector observers: the close result (45-51) means Perspectives is not firmly anti-union; a second drive is likely within the next biannual cycle. Failed drives at large networks are often more important intelligence than successful certifications at small independents — they reveal organizing momentum and employer vulnerability.

THE MULTI-UNIT CHARTER — ASPIRA AS THE ENDPOINT OF MATURE ORGANIZING

ASPIRA of Illinois achieved four separate NLRB certifications over 6 years: CTU-ACTS teachers; IFT Local 4343 guidance counselors and mentors (RC-176024, June 2016, 6-0 vote); IFT paraprofessionals (RC-210456, December 2017, 8-0 vote); IUOE Local 399 skilled maintenance workers (RC-293154, April 2022, 2-0 vote). This multi-unit structure is the logical endpoint of a mature organizing relationship where successively smaller employee groups achieve their own certifications over time. It is also the most financially complex scenario for a charter operator: four separate bargaining processes, four separate contracts, four separate renewal cycles.

Charter leaders who think union exposure is limited to "a teacher union" should understand that ASPIRA's experience — organizing waves that covered progressively smaller groups over time — is the pattern for fully organized multi-campus networks.

STATE NEUTRALITY LAW AS GAME-CHANGER — HB 1120 AND THE CHANGED LANDSCAPE

Illinois HB 1120 (August 2023) requires union neutrality clauses in all charter contract renewals. If upheld by federal courts, this law makes it legally impossible for CPS-authorized charter operators to campaign against unionization as a condition of keeping their charter. The pre-2023 counter-organizing playbook — captive audience meetings, direct anti-union communications, management-side labor consultants — becomes a charter renewal risk. This fundamentally changes the strategic calculus for the 75+ non-union IL charter campuses not in the NAPCS dataset. Noble Schools, KIPP Chicago, LEARN, and Perspectives built their non-union status on employer neutrality being a choice, not a mandate. HB 1120 removes that choice for CPS-authorized schools.

CICS Network Undercount: ChicagoQuest as Fourth Organized Campus Missing from NAPCS (Session C)

Session C identified CICS ChicagoQuest High School (known as "Chicago Quest North" in INCS/NAPCS nomenclature) as a fourth organized CICS campus not in the NAPCS 3-school baseline (Northtown, Wrightwood, Ralph Ellison). ChicagoQuest participated in the February 2019 multi-employer CICS strike alongside the three NAPCS-listed campuses — confirming shared CTU certification. ChicagoQuest was organized in a near-unanimous 96% vote (~2014) under IFT Local 4343 before transitioning to CTU. The school is also covered by the second CICS unit (RC-248092, Oct 2019, office/support staff). The gap between NAPCS-listed CICS schools (3) and actually organized CICS schools (4+ confirmed) is a further example of the campus-counting undercount problem documented in the IL cross-state pattern "THE NAPCS UNDERCOUNT PROBLEM." This adds to the Illinois registry vs. NAPCS discrepancy (53 confirmed vs. 26 NAPCS-listed).

Section 5: Media Coverage & Public Stakeholder Positions

Press Coverage

Illinois charter school labor relations have generated more sustained press coverage than any other state in the NAPCS dataset except California. WBEZ (Chicago Public Radio) and Chalkbeat Chicago have provided ongoing coverage of CTU-ACTS organizing campaigns, strikes, and contract negotiations since 2015. The Chicago Tribune and Chicago Sun-Times have covered major events: the 2018 Acero strike (first charter school strike in Chicago history), the 2019 CICS strike, and the series of school closures at Acero (2025) and ASPIRA (2026). The closure wave has generated significant education community coverage, with Chalkbeat documenting displaced students and unresolved CBA obligations.

Union Communications

CTU (Chicago Teachers Union) and ChiACTS are the primary public communicators. CTU maintains a contracts portal with publicly accessible CBAs for organized charter networks. The CTU/ChiACTS model is the most sophisticated charter-specific communications infrastructure in the NAPCS dataset — including dedicated social media, press releases for each certification, and public CBA posting. CTU President Stacy Davis Gates has cited charter organizing as a strategic priority.

Employer / School Communications

Acero Schools publicly announced its closure decision in late 2024, affecting 13 organized campuses. ASPIRA Inc. of Illinois announced closure of both NAPCS schools (Business & Finance, Early College) in spring 2026. EPIC Academy announced closure effective June 2026. The closure wave represents the most significant organized-school-closure event in the full 584-school NAPCS dataset — all closing schools are CTU-ACTS certified.

Legislative Context

Illinois presents a split jurisdictional framework unique in the NAPCS dataset: NLRB governs privately incorporated charter operators (most IL charters); IELRB governs ISBE-authorized and district-dependent charters (e.g., Springfield Ball). The 2011 Illinois Educational Labor Relations Act (IELRA) amendments clarified state-board-authorized charter status. CTU's political

power — including its role in mayor elections — has made IL charter labor relations a state political issue in ways not seen in most other NAPCS states.

Section 6: Contract & CBA Access Registry

NLRB (Region 13) / IELRB public contracts portal. Direct PDF links may return 403 — OPRA or equivalent records request required for full text.

School / Network	Union	CBA Status & Term	Contract Access
	United Educators for Justice / CTU-ACTS	Active Unknown — records request needed	CTU contracts portal; NLRB Region 13 records request
	ChiACTS / CTU-ACTS	Active 2018-2022 (confirmed); renewal status unconfirmed	CTU contracts portal (ChicagoQuest, Ellison, Northtown and Wrightwood 2018-22)
	ChiACTS / Youth Connections	Active CTU 2018-22 (Latino Youth confirmed); others unknown	CTU contracts portal; NLRB Region 13 records request
	ChiACTS (original cert: IFT Local 4343)	Active First contract ratified June 2021; successor unconfirmed	CTU/NLRB records request; FOIA if needed
	Prairie Crossing Federation of Teachers and Support Staff / IFT	Active (assumed) Unknown	IELRB records request; IFT affiliate inquiry

Section 7: Decisions, Monitoring & Notable Findings

Part A: Decisions Required

The following items require sponsor action before research or workbook entry can proceed.

Priority	School / Scope	Item	Who
HIGH	Namaste Elementary, Jackson Charter School, YCCS West	NAPCS addition decisions pending for 3 discovery schools	Reviewer / Executive Sponsor
REVIEWER_DECISION	CICS ChicagoQuest (IL-004) and Urban Prep West (IL-005)	Sponsor NAPCS addition decisions needed for 2 new Session C discovery schools	Executive Sponsor

Part B: Notable Findings

Research findings of strategic significance. No immediate action required — for awareness and discussion.

No notable findings flagged for this state.

Part C: Active Monitoring

Items being tracked. Status may change between report cycles. Research Coordinator manages ongoing surveillance.

Priority	School / Scope	Item	Who
HIGH	5 Acero CPS reabsorption campuses	Status code update required at CPS transition (fall 2026)	Research Coordinator
MEDIUM	Perspectives Charter Schools (non-NAPCS)	Monitor for CTU re-filing — Perspectives is now highest-priority unorganized Chicago charter network	Research Coordinator
MEDIUM	Noble Schools (non-NAPCS)	Monitor for organizing activity — 17 campuses, ~800 staff, highest-priority non-union target	Research Coordinator
MEDIUM	Prairie Crossing — support staff third petition	Monitor for third NLRB petition from Prairie Crossing support staff	Research Coordinator
HIGH	Noble Schools (17 campuses)	CTU organizing drive — RC petition filing — 2017 drive failed before election. HB 1120 removes neutrality-violation option. Highest-priority non-union IL charter target. ~800 staff.	Research Coordinator
HIGH	Perspectives Charter Schools (4 campuses)	CTU re-filing — RC petition — CTU lost Aug 2024 election (45-51, RC-341523). Network will be CTU target for re-organizing. Election result suggests it is winnable without employer misconduct.	Research Coordinator
HIGH	HB 1120 / Card-Check Law — federal court	Court ruling on neutrality mandate and card-check law — If upheld: materially accelerates IL charter organizing. If struck: restores pre-2023 employer playbook. Biannual cycle should update state report based on ruling.	Research Coordinator
MEDIUM	Prairie Crossing support staff	Third NLRB or IELRB organizing petition — Two prior withdrawn petitions. Recurring interest. Teacher unit already organized (IFT).	Research Coordinator
MEDIUM	KIPP Chicago (non-NAPCS)	CTU or other union organizing — Major national CMO with zero IL labor board activity to date. HB 1120 changes their legal exposure.	Research Coordinator
HIGH	CICS ChicagoQuest High School (NAPCS-ADD-IL-004)	Open/closed status + first contract status. CICS closed ChicagoQuest in 2020 attempt but staff fought it off. School remains at risk of closure. Monitor ISBE and CPS for charter renewal decisions. Also monitor for successor CBA to 2018-22 CICS/CTU contract.	Research Coordinator
LOW	Urban Prep West (NAPCS-ADD-IL-005)	Historical record only — closed June 2023. Sponsor NAPCS addition decision pending. No monitoring action required.	Research Coordinator